`$credentials['username']`. The method should return an `Authenticatable` implementation. This method should not attempt to validate or authenticate passwords.

To authenticate the user, the `validateCredentials` function should match the provided `$user` to the `$credentials`. For example, to compare the value of `$user->getAuthPassword()` to the value of `$credentials['password']`, this function will often utilize the `Hash::check` method. This method should return `true` or `false` depending on whether it is valid.

Authenticatable Contract

Now that we've gone over each function on the `UserProvider`, let's look at the `Authenticatable` contract.